

Morality is reality



‘What sort of philosophy one chooses depends on what sort of person one is.’ – Johann Gottlieb Fichte

Kant’s version of idealism was taken a step further in the philosophy of Johann Gottlieb Fichte. Although an admirer of Kant, Fichte dismissed the concept of the *noumenon*, or thing-in-itself, and proposed a system of absolute idealism, in which external reality is the creation of the knowing mind.

Hume and Kant had shown that scientific laws could not be derived from empirical observations (see [Phenomenon and noumenon](#)), but Fichte believed that the converse is possible. He believed that the laws of physics proposed by Newton, for example, were true, and argued that we have an innate idea of the structure of the universe, from which we deduce empirical reality. The knowing subject, what he calls the 'I', is the cause of external reality, the 'not-I'. In this view, the self is not a passive observer but is active and free to make choices, implying that our existence is essentially moral. From this, Fichte argued that reality, as a creation of that moral self, must also be fundamentally moral in character.